

Depth buys nothing: the probe is reading surface text

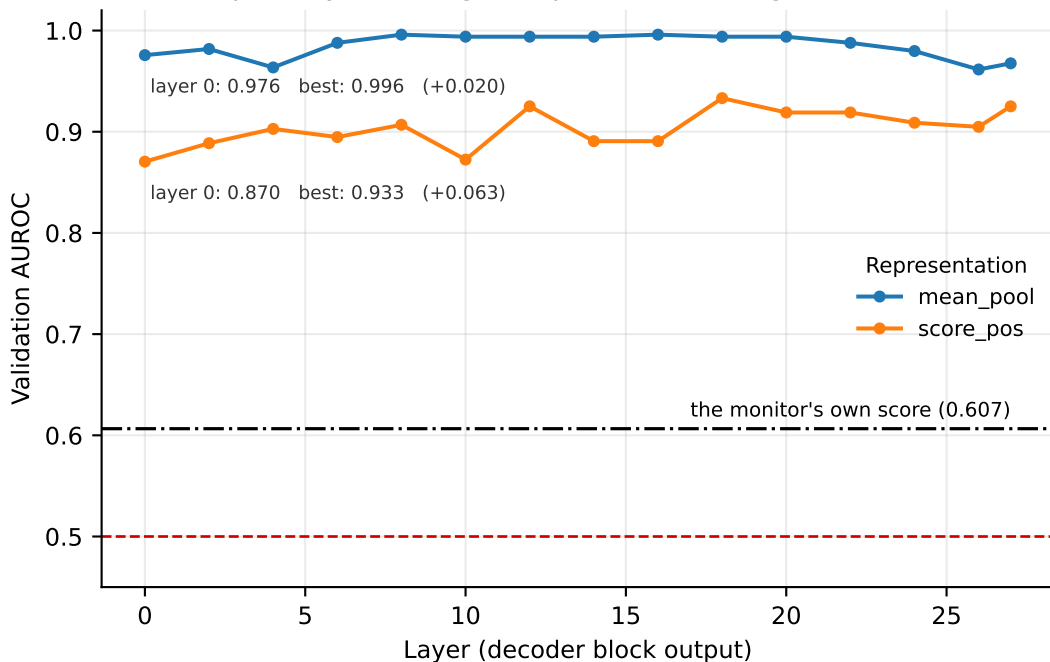


Figure 6. Per-layer validation AUROC for the linear probe. Layer 0 is the output of the FIRST decoder block, so almost no monitoring computation has happened there -- yet mean-pooled activations already separate the classes near-perfectly, and twenty-six further blocks add almost nothing. The monitor's own considered score, after all 28 blocks, is the dash-dotted line far below. A probe recovering the monitor's judgement would rise with depth and would not start above the monitor. This is the diagnostic that identified the result as confounded.